

Dear Dr. Kilteni,

I am writing to express my strong interest in the Research Assistant position in the Somatosensation and Gargalesis group at the Donders Institute. With a Master's degree in Medical Biology from Radboud University and hands-on research experience in neuroscience and behavioral studies, I am excited about the opportunity to contribute to your team's work exploring the mechanisms of somatosensation.

My academic journey has included extensive education and hands-on training in both biomedical and behavioral research. During my Bachelor's in Biology, I received rigorous training in physiology, molecular biology, and electrophysiology. This included a wide range of wet lab techniques such as PCR, ELISA, patch clamp, and behavioral testing (*Wistar* rats). I complemented my studies with a role as a Junior Research Assistant in a fundamental research project investigating the mechanisms of arterial tone regulation. Later, as part of my MSc internship at the Donders Institute, I investigated neuronal networks of memory using *in vivo* calcium imaging in the retrosplenial cortex of mice engaged in virtual social learning. This role required not only animal handling and surgical procedures (craniotomy), but also data analysis using Python and DeepLabCut. My academic training emphasized experimental design, data collection, and collaboration across interdisciplinary teams – skills that align closely with the demands of this role.

Additionally, I bring strong organizational skills developed through my experience in clinical research at LABMGUMU, where I supported over 35 clinical and bioequivalence trials, conducted user interviews, and ensured accurate documentation and regulatory compliance. My ability to manage participant data, schedule and track project timelines, and maintain research integrity will allow me to contribute effectively to your team's behavioural studies, MEG/MRI data collection, and participant recruitment. I am comfortable with participant-facing roles and have experience managing recruitment, informed consent, and data documentation in both academic and clinical settings.

I am fluent in English and am actively improving my Dutch fluency. I am also highly proactive, team-oriented, and genuinely passionate about neuroscience research. The collaborative and high-standard research environment at the Donders Institute has always inspired me, and I would be thrilled to continue contributing to it in this new capacity.

Thank you for considering my application. I would be delighted to discuss how my education, research experience, and motivation align with your team's goals.

Kind regards,  
Varvara Lazarenko